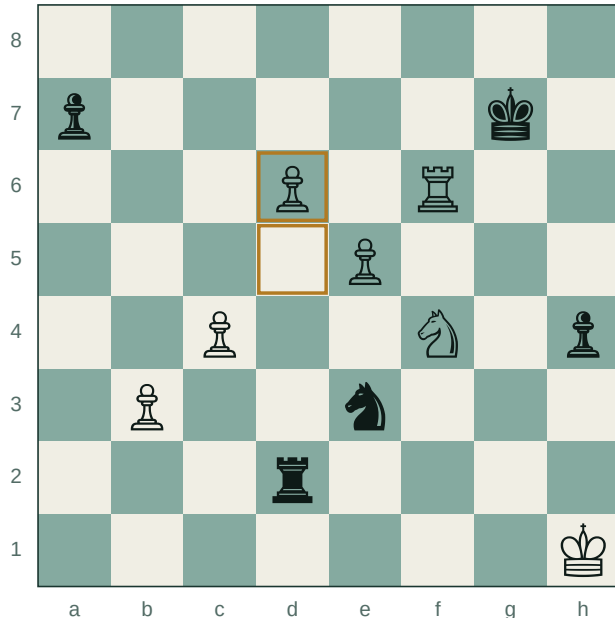


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 42

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 42.d6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42...Rd1+ 43. Kh2 Ng4+ 44. Kh3 Nxf6

42...Rd1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **43.Kh2**.

43...Ng4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From g4 it attacks king on h2 and rook on f6. Recorded reply: **44.Kh3**.

44...Nxf6 The knight captures the rook on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on h1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.